

The Great Shift:

**Isra, Miraj, and the
Pledges**

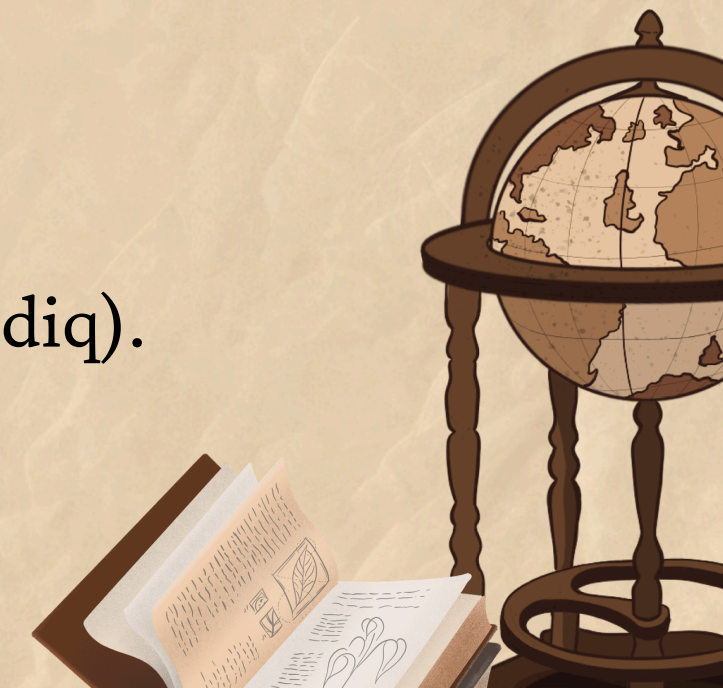




Al-Isra' wal-Mi'raj: The Miraculous Journey

Occurred around the 10th–12th year of Prophethood, known as the "Year of Sorrow" (Aam al-Huzn).

- **The Horizontal Journey (Al-Isra')**: The night travel from Masjid al-Haram (Makkah) to Masjid al-Aqsa (Jerusalem) on the Buraq.
- **The Vertical Ascension (Al-Mi'raj)**: The journey through the seven heavens, meeting previous Prophets (e.g., Isa, Musa, Ibrahim AS), culminating at the Sidrat al-Muntaha (The Lote Tree of the Utmost Boundary).
- **The Divine Gift (Salat)**: This is where the 50 daily prayers were reduced to five, yet retaining the reward of 50.
- **Significance**: A transition from local persecution to universal leadership.
 - The validation of the Prophet's ﷺ status.
 - The testing of the Sahaba's faith (e.g., Abu Bakr RA earning the title Al-Siddiq).

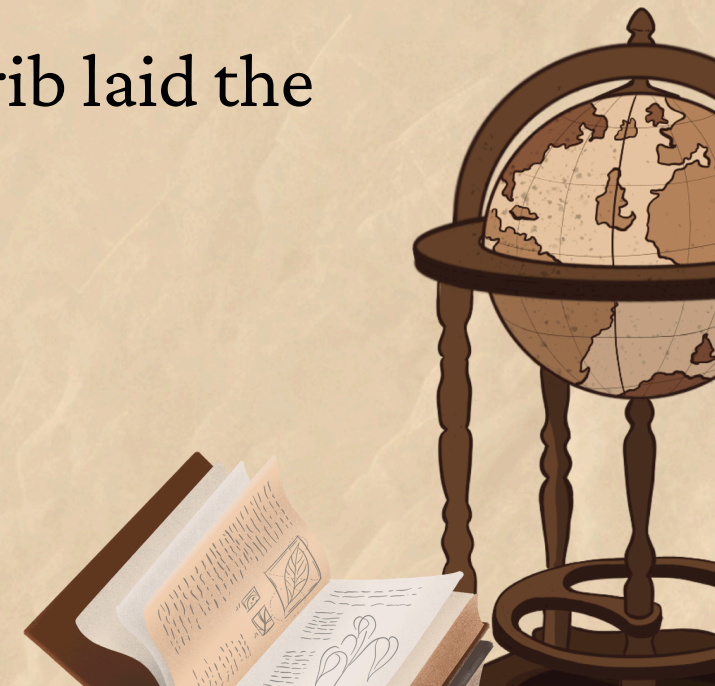




The First Aqabah Pledge

Context: 12th year of Prophethood. 12 men from the tribes of Aus and Khazraj (Yathrib) met the Prophet ﷺ at a mountain pass called Aqabah.

- **The Terms (Social & Ethical Protocol):** Unlike later pledges, this did not involve military defense. It focused on:
 - Monotheism (avoiding Shirk).
 - Abstaining from theft, adultery, and infanticide.
 - Refraining from slander.
 - Obedience to the Prophet ﷺ in all that is good.
- **The "Beta Test" of Da'wah:** The Prophet ﷺ sent Mus'ab bin Umayr (the first ambassador) back to Yathrib to teach the Quran.
- **Outcome:** This was a period of cultural preparation. Mus'ab's success in Yathrib laid the groundwork for a state, not just a following.





The Second Aqabah Pledge (The Pledge of War/Protection)

Context: 13th year of Prophethood. 73 men and 2 women from Yathrib met secretly at night during Hajj.

- **The Strategic Shift:** This was a political and defensive treaty. The people of Yathrib pledged to protect the Prophet ﷺ as they would protect their own families.
- **The Selection of Leaders (Nuqaba):** The Prophet ﷺ asked them to select 12 leaders (Nuqaba) to represent their tribes, effectively creating a decentralized leadership structure.
- **The Risk Factor:** Abbas warned the Yathribites: "If you think you can carry out what you have promised, then do it. If not, leave him now."
- **Impact:** This pledge was the green light for the Hijrah. It transformed Islam from a persecuted faith into a political entity with a secure base.

